

The Service Module separated from the Command Module, which was re-oriented to a heat-shield-forward position. Deploying its parachute after a flight of 195 hours, 18 minutes, 35 seconds, Apollo 11 splashed down in the Pacific Ocean and Armstrong, Aldrin and Collins received a hysterical welcome from everyone on Earth.

Apollo 12-17 and cancellation

Following the success of the Apollo 11 mission in stamping the supremacy of the American space programmed, NASA wasted no time in sending more astronauts to the moon.

On November 14, 1969, Apollo 12 took off with Charles Conrad, Alan Bean and Richard Gordon on board. Everything went off successfully and on November 19, Conrad and Bean became the third and fourth men to step on the moon, respectively.

In their first lunar exploration, Conrad spent 3 hours, 39 minutes outside the Lunar Module, and Bean logged 2 hours, 58 minutes. During this EVA, Conrad collected lunar surface samples and deployed both the S-band communication antenna and the solar wind experiment. The new Apollo Lunar Surface Scientific Experiments Package (ALSEP) was deployed within an arc of 600 to 700 feet of the LM. The ALSEP functioned satisfactorily, except for two items in the package, and was expected to yield data for up to two years.

Throughout this first EVA, Conrad and Bean also took photographs of the experiment equipment, the spacecraft, the lurain (lunar terrain) and of themselves. Before entering the Intrepid, Bean took a 16-inch-deep core sample of the lunar surface and was followed back into the LM by Conrad. The second EVA included the collection of 70 pounds of rock and dirt samples, the retrieval of 10 to 15 pounds of randomly selected samples and further probing of two areas to retrieve lunar material from depths up to 32 inches below the surface. The most important part of this second EVA was a 5,200-foot traverse of the lurain, ranging up to 1,300 feet from the LM.

On November 20, they departed to rendezvous with the CSM and the Apollo 12 crew returned home without any glitches on November 24.

Apollo 13, launched on April 11, 1970, was the only flight after Armstrong's historic journey that had a problem and didn't land on the moon. After reaching lunar orbit, astronauts James Lovell, Fred Haise and John Swigert aborted their mission upon detecting a rupture in the Service Module oxygen tank. This would be the point where Swigert uttered the